

A program of
Stamford Peace Youth Foundation

ARTICLES INFORMING AND REINFORCING OUR WORK

THE SKILLS STUDENTS NEED MOST TO SUCCEED IN FUTURE JOBS

College & Workforce Readiness, April 2025

"The world of work is being fundamentally changed by AI...However, the top skills required to navigate complexity and change remain uniquely human with **emotional intelligence, cognitive flexibility, and communication** referenced as top skills leaders believe will be essential for employees in an **AI-powered future.**"

WHY SCHOOL ISN'T WORKING FOR MANY BOYS AND WHAT COULD HELP

EdWeek Research Center, January 2025

"Teachers see boys, overall, as having more trouble sitting still, less focused and engaged in class, less willing to take on leadership roles, and generally less motivated to perform academically...The combination of more stringent academic expectations and less time for unstructured play might contribute to boys' disproportionately high disciplinary rates, which start in the youngest grades."

THE TEEN DISENGAGEMENT CRISIS

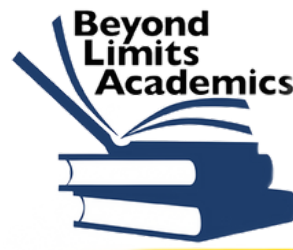
The Atlantic, February 2025

"These kids turn up. They do their homework. They get good-enough grades. They comply, which in academic terms means they're behaviorally engaged. But **they're not investing in what they're learning**, nor are they that interested in trying to make sense of it."

"Disengagement works on a continuum:

If kids start to lose interest, then after a while, many stop doing their work; if they stop doing their work, they're likely to fall behind; if they fall behind, they might feel as if they're out of options, and **soon apathy becomes the norm.**"

"When parents [command] that homework be completed, achievement drops and students are less engaged...Nagging also diminishes teens' sense of autonomy...**Sometimes the negative consequences of not getting work done or failing an exam are exactly what a kid needs to feel motivated.**"



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A DISMAL REPORT CARD IN MATH AND READING

The Hechinger Report, January 2025

"Results of a major national test...showed that in 2024, reading and math skills of 4th and 8th grade students were **significantly below those of students in 2019**, the last administration of the test before the pandemic...The results were especially disappointing after the federal government gave schools \$190 billion to aid in pandemic recovery."

"The most striking thing in the results is the increase in inequality...The huge pandemic learning losses for students in the bottom 10% grew 70% larger between 2022 and 2024. Learning losses for students in the bottom 25% grew 25% larger."

"Results show that **more children lack even the most basic skills**. In math, 24% of 4th graders and 39% of 8th graders cannot reach the lowest of three achievement levels, called "basic"...These are 4th graders who cannot locate whole numbers on a number line or 8th graders who cannot understand scientific notation."

A SMALLER NATION'S REPORT CARD

The Hechinger Report, April 2025

"The National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP)...is taken by a sample of 450,000 students who are selected to represent all the 4th and 8th graders in the nation...Significant changes to the exam or its administration **could make it impossible to compare student achievement** with the 2024 results, potentially undermining the whole purpose of the assessment."

A LOT OF HOPE WAS PINNED ON AFTER-SCHOOL PROGRAMS – NOW THEY'RE SHUTTING THEIR DOORS

The Hechinger Report, April 2025

"Done well, after-school programs can strengthen students' **social and emotional skills**, increase their **engagement with and attendance** in school, and reduce their risk of **substance abuse or criminal activity**. In some cases, they can help improve grades and test scores too."